CHRISCO Youth Aflame
CHRISCO DIGITAL ACADEMY | CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

Email Marketing Course Handbook

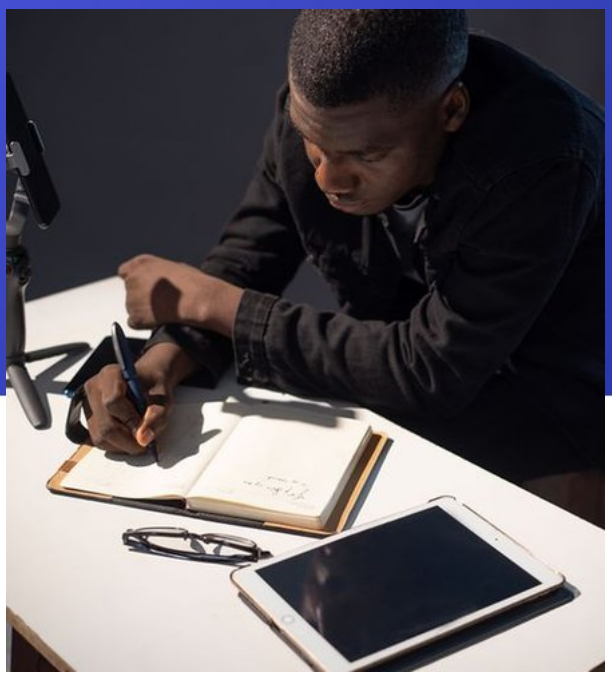
"Build a list and turn subscribers into loyal customers."



Retention & Direct Response Track | 6 Weeks | All Levels Self-Paced Study Edition

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Course Foreword



Email marketing quietly outperforms almost every other channel on return for money spent. Why? Because an email list is an audience you own outright, not rented from a social platform that can change its rules or bury your posts tomorrow.

For any business, freelancer or creator, learning email marketing means learning to build and profit from a direct relationship with people who chose to hear from you. It is a skill you can sell and one that pays a business back for years.

THE PRACTITIONER PROMISE

You will learn to grow an email list, choose the right tools, write emails people open and act on, automate sequences, personalise at scale, and improve with data.

Apply each chapter to a real or imagined business. The exercises build, step by step, into a complete email strategy you can actually run.

Published by CHRISCO Digital Academy under CHRISCO Youth Aflame (*CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches*), this 8-module workbook equips youth and emerging leaders with practical, ethical, income-ready skills. Complete every chapter drill in a dedicated workbook and reach our mentorship desk anytime at chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com.



Key Outcomes

01

Introduction to email marketing: Email reaches an audience you own directly.

02

Choosing an email platform: Use a proper email platform, not personal Gmail.

03

Automating email sequences: Set up sequences once; they run automatically.

04

Analytics and optimisation: A campaign coordinates emails toward one goal.

Across 6 Weeks of structured practice, learners progress from core principles to real-world execution. Every module pairs concise frameworks with an immediate hands-on drill so knowledge turns into demonstrable competence.

Graduates finish with a tangible portfolio deliverable in Email Marketing, ready to serve clients, employers, ministries, and communities with excellence and integrity.

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01
Foundations & Core Mindset

Module 1: Introduction to email marketing | Module 2: Building your email list



1.1 Introduction to email marketing

Email marketing is using email to build relationships and drive sales, sending valuable, relevant messages to people who've given you permission to contact them. Unlike social media, you're not fighting an algorithm or renting attention; you reach subscribers directly. That ownership and directness are why email returns so much for every shilling spent.

The mindset that matters: email is about relationship, not spam. You earn the right to sell by consistently providing value and respecting the reader. Done well, your emails are welcomed, opened and acted on. Done badly (constant selling, irrelevant blasts), people unsubscribe. Treat your list as a privilege, and it becomes a powerful, lasting asset.

Real-World Example: A creator with a modest email list of a few hundred true fans launched a product and made more sales than a rival with tens of thousands of passive social followers, because email reached people directly and personally, and they trusted her.

Hands-On Practice: Write down why email marketing suits a business you know, and what value you could send its customers that they'd actually want.

Core Takeaways: Email reaches an audience you own directly. • It's about relationship, not spam. • A respected list is a lasting asset.

1.2 Building your email list

You can't do email marketing without subscribers, and people won't hand over their email for nothing. You need a 'lead magnet', something valuable offered in exchange for signing up: a discount, a useful guide, a checklist, a free resource. The better and more relevant the offer, the faster your list grows with the right people.

Place sign-up opportunities where your audience is, on your website, social profiles, at checkout, in your content. Always get genuine permission (never buy or scrape lists, it's ineffective and often illegal). Focus on quality over sheer size: a smaller list of genuinely interested people is far more valuable than a huge list of the indifferent.

01

Practitioner Case

An online tutor offered a free 'exam preparation checklist' in exchange for an email. Students happily signed up, and she then nurtured them toward her paid classes. The free, relevant lead magnet built a list of exactly the right people.

02

Action Drill

Design a lead magnet for your chosen business: what valuable free thing would its ideal customer gladly give their email for? Write its title.

03

Key Standard

Offer a valuable lead magnet to earn sign-ups. Put sign-up options where your audience is. Quality of subscribers beats raw quantity.



02
Core Frameworks & Strategy

Module 3: Choosing an email platform | Module 4: Writing compelling emails

2.1 Choosing an email platform

You need an email marketing tool (like Mailchimp, MailerLite, and others) to manage subscribers, send bulk emails legally and professionally, and automate sequences, never use your personal Gmail for this. Most have free tiers generous enough for beginners, so cost is not a barrier to starting properly.

Choose based on ease of use and the features you'll actually need: list management, templates, automation, and analytics. Don't overthink it, pick a beginner-friendly platform, learn it well, and switch later only if you outgrow it. The tool matters less than how you use it; a simple platform used skilfully beats a powerful one used poorly.

Core Principle

Use a proper email platform, not personal Gmail.

Field Case Study

A small business owner started with a free MailerLite account, imported her sign-ups, and sent her first professional newsletter with a ready template in an afternoon. The free tool did everything she needed to begin earning from email.

Applied Exercise

Create a free account on a beginner-friendly email platform. Explore how to add a subscriber, use a template, and send a test email to yourself.

Mastery Check

Free tiers are enough to start. · Ease of use matters more than fancy features.

2.2 Three-Step Execution Rhythm

Step 1

Prepare & Frame
Use a proper email platform, not personal Gmail.

Practice Focus
Audit your current approach before acting.

Step 2

Execute Deliberately
Free tiers are enough to start.

Practice Focus
Focus on clarity, calm pace, and measurable value.

Step 3

Review & Refine
Ease of use matters more than fancy features.

Practice Focus
Record outcomes and sharpen one habit per rep.

2.3 Writing compelling emails

A great marketing email has three jobs: get opened, get read, and get action. The subject line earns the open (make it intriguing or clearly valuable, never clickbait that disappoints). The body earns attention with a friendly, personal tone and one clear message. And a single, obvious call to action tells the reader exactly what to do next.

Write like a human talking to one person, not a corporation broadcasting. Keep it focused, resist cramming multiple offers into one email. Provide value or interest, not just constant selling, so people keep opening your future emails. Consistency of a welcome, valuable voice is what turns a list into loyal customers.

01

Subject line gets the open; body gets the read.

02

One email, one message, one action.

03

Sound human; mix value with offers.

2.4 Real-World Case & Lab Assignment

Practitioner Case Study

A shop's emails were ignored until they switched from formal 'Dear valued customer' blasts to warm, personal notes with one clear offer and a friendly tone. Opens and sales rose, people respond to a human, not a megaphone.

Your Practical Assignment

Write one complete marketing email: an intriguing subject line, a warm personal opening, one clear message, and one call to action.

CHRISCO Youth Aflame Study Principle: "Subject line gets the open; body gets the read. Consistent execution in small daily assignments builds authority that cannot be faked."



03
Execution & Applied Mastery

Module 5: Automating email sequences | Module 6: Segmentation and personalisation

3.1 Automating email sequences

Automation is email marketing's superpower: you set up sequences once, and they run automatically for every new subscriber. The most important is a 'welcome sequence', a series of emails that greets new subscribers, delivers value, tells your story, and gently leads them toward a purchase, all without you lifting a finger after setup.

Automations can also handle things like abandoned carts, post-purchase follow-ups, and re-engaging inactive subscribers. This means the right message reaches the right person at the right time, at scale, while you sleep. Setting up smart automations is what makes email marketing efficient and, frankly, close to passive income for a business.



Case: An online store set up a 3-email welcome sequence: a warm hello, a helpful tip, then a first-purchase discount. Every new subscriber now gets nurtured automatically, and a steady share buy, all running on autopilot after one setup.

Action Drill: Outline a 3-email welcome sequence for your business: email 1 (welcome + value), email 2 (build trust/story), email 3 (a clear offer).

3.2 Segmentation and personalisation

Not all subscribers are the same, and treating them identically wastes the power of email. Segmentation means grouping your list (by interest, behaviour, purchase history, or location) so you can send more relevant messages to each group. A relevant email to the right segment vastly outperforms a generic blast to everyone.

Personalisation goes further, using the subscriber's name, referencing their past actions, and tailoring content to feel one-to-one. Modern platforms make this easy. The more relevant and personal your emails feel, the more they're opened, trusted and acted on. People engage with messages that feel like they were written for them, because effectively they were.



Case: A store sent past buyers of running shoes a targeted email about new running gear, while sending beginners a 'getting started' guide. Both segments responded far better than a single generic email would, relevance drove the results.

Action Drill: For your business, define two or three subscriber segments and one tailored message you'd send to each.



04
Scaling, Capstone & Excellence

Module 7: Analytics and optimisation | Module 8: Run a full email campaign

4.1 Analytics and optimisation

Email is highly measurable, so improvement is straightforward if you watch the right numbers. Key metrics: open rate (are subject lines working?), click rate (is the content and call to action compelling?), and conversions (are people actually buying or acting?). Also watch unsubscribes, a spike means you're sending too much or the wrong things.

Use these numbers to improve continuously. Test different subject lines, send times, and content, and keep what performs (this is called A/B testing). Small, steady optimisations compound into big gains over time. The marketer who reads the data and adjusts will always outperform the one who just keeps sending the same emails and hoping.

Field Example: A newsletter's opens were low until the sender tested shorter, curiosity-driven subject lines. One style clearly won, opens climbed, and every future email benefited, a simple test, found by watching the data, that paid off repeatedly. | Drill: List the three email metrics you'll track and write one simple A/B test you'd run (e.g. two subject lines) to improve results.

4.2 Run a full email campaign (Capstone)

Your final project ties it all together: plan a complete email campaign for a real or imagined business. Define the goal (e.g. launch a product, drive sales), your lead magnet and how you'll grow the list, your welcome sequence, and the campaign emails themselves, plus how you'll measure success. A campaign is a coordinated set of emails driving toward one objective.

Then, ideally, run it for real, even a small version. Build the list, send the sequence, watch the numbers, and learn. This hands-on experience turns email marketing from theory into a demonstrable skill you can sell to businesses or use to grow your own. Email rewards the consistent: keep nurturing your list and it keeps paying back.

Competency Area	Capstone Standard	Starting	Target Mastery
1. Clarity & Preparation	Track opens, clicks, conversions and unsubscribes.	Needs Draft	Confident & Ready
2. Execution Quality	A campaign coordinates emails toward one goal.	In Practice	Portfolio-Grade
3. Real-World Proof	Plan a full email campaign on one page: goal, lead magnet, welcome sequence, campaign emails, and metrics. Run a small version if you can.	Planned	Completed & Reviewed
4. Consistency Habit	Consistent nurturing keeps a list paying back.	Occasional	Weekly Discipline

5.1 Complete 8-Module Practice Matrix

Use this checklist to track every hands-on assignment in Email Marketing from Module 1 to your final project:

Module	Focus Topic	Core Deliverable & Principle
Module 01	Introduction to email marketing	Email reaches an audience you own directly.
Module 02	Building your email list	Offer a valuable lead magnet to earn sign-ups.
Module 03	Choosing an email platform	Use a proper email platform, not personal Gmail.
Module 04	Writing compelling emails	Subject line gets the open; body gets the read.
Module 05	Automating email sequences	Set up sequences once; they run automatically.
Module 06	Segmentation and personalisation	Segment your list to stay relevant.
Module 07	Analytics and optimisation	Track opens, clicks, conversions and unsubscribes.
Module 08	Run a full email campaign	A campaign coordinates emails toward one goal.

5.2 Applied Fellowship Reflections

"A creator with a modest email list of a few hundred true fans launched a product and made more sales than a rival with tens of thousands of passive social followers, because email reached people directly and personally, and they trusted her."

CHRISCO Youth Aflame Cohort Case Note | Module 01





"A learner ran a small campaign for a friend's bakery: a free-recipe lead magnet grew a list, a welcome sequence built trust, and a launch email for a new product drove real weekend orders, a full campaign, real results, a proven skill."

CHRISCO Digital Academy Capstone Highlight | Module 08

06 90-Day Action Roadmap

True mastery in Email Marketing is measured by what you build, ship, and steward after finishing the lessons. Follow this structured 90-day implementation plan developed by CHRISCO Youth Aflame (under CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches) to turn study into fruitfulness.

6.1 Four-Stage Post-Course Milestones

01

Days 1 to 14: Foundation Sprint

Complete Modules 1 to 4 drills and document your baseline specimen in Email Marketing.

02

Days 15 to 30: First Live Output

Complete Modules 5 to 8 and ship your first real capstone deliverable: Plan a full email campaign on one page: goal, lead magnet, welcome sequence, campaign emails, and metrics. Run a small version if you can.

03

Days 31 to 60: Feedback & Iteration

Share your work with a mentor, peer, or real client/community audience and refine weak points.

04

Days 61 to 90: Service & Multiplication

Use your skill to serve your church, business, or clients faithfully and mentor one younger learner.

Follow-Up Stage	CHRISCO Support Channel	Contact & Cadence
Workbook Review	CHRISCO Digital Academy Desk	chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com
Capstone Submission	CHRISCO Youth Aflame Mentors	shambetz@gmail.com
Peer Accountability	CHRISCO Fellowship Study Hubs	Monthly Cohort Check-In

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Equipping Youth, Elevating Purpose

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